

Finding Tower Research's Chicago network owner

Account entry plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: HubSpot, Lemlist, ZoomInfo, Apollo

97 Colocation intent, audience B (Sep 12)	6 network-relevant intent topics in September	25 Tower contacts in HubSpot	0 conversations so far
STAGE Prospect (briefing: Bandwidth intent 80). No deal.	RUNNING NOW CTF ENT - Practitioners (Aks Zehra, Allison Chen); CTF INTL (Cherry Tang); added Sep 29-30	LAST TOUCH Sep 30: Leaders task snoozed; no emails logged yet	NEXT STEP Mon Oct 5: email Mike Alford (Network Architecture)

Bottom line

Tower Research is a 1,000-person global HFT firm headquartered in New York, and it lit up ZoomInfo in September with **six network-relevant intent topics: Colocation 97, Data Center 91, Bandwidth 80, Networking Solutions 74 and Networking/Telecom 74**. Chicago is core to any HFT firm trading US futures. HubSpot holds 25 Tower contacts, almost all network and data center engineers, but no one has had a real touch yet. The person to start with is **Mike Alford (Network Architecture)**, who came up through Virtu and KCG; the telecom engineer **Allison Chen** is the natural technical partner.

What Tower is, in one analogy

An HFT firm is a Formula 1 team: the car (algorithms) matters, but races are lost on the pit lane (the network). Tower already has a pit crew; you're offering a second, separate pit lane in Chicago in case the first one is blocked.

Signals worth citing

Signal	Source	So what for the opener
Colocation 97 (B), Cloud Computing 97 (A), Data Center 91 (D) on Sep 12; Bandwidth 80, Networking Solutions 74, Networking/Telecom 74 on Sep 26	ZoomInfo intent	Broad, sustained network and facility research.
Operations open roles at a 9-month high (Sep 5)	ZoomInfo scoop	Operations growth; context.
Mike Alford: Network Architecture since Mar 2024; ex-Virtu, KCG	Apollo	Designs the network; speaks trading latency.
Allison Chen, Telecom Engineer (HubSpot)	HubSpot, Lemlist	Telecom is literally her job: carrier circuits and fiber.

Work already in motion

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Sep 29-30	CTF ENT - Practitioners	Aks Zehra (Sr Network Eng) and Allison Chen (Telecom Eng) enrolled	No messages yet
Sep 30	CTF INTL - Email-only	Cherry Tang (Director of Technology, APAC) enrolled	Wrong region
Sep 30	CTF ENT - Leaders	Task snoozed for 21 hours; duplicate draft removed	-

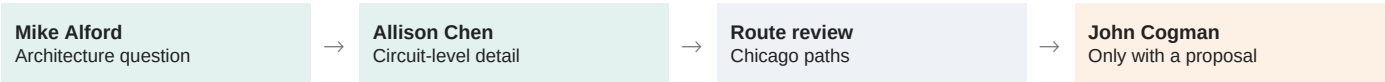
Who to reach, in order

Contact	Title (source)	Where	Why they matter	Status / email
Mike Alford	Network Architecture (HubSpot, Apollo). Ex-Virtu, KCG.	New York	Network architect.	Not contacted. malford@tower-research.com
Allison Chen	Telecom Engineer (HubSpot)	n/a	Owns carrier and fiber circuits.	CTF ENT Practitioners, Sep 30
Ben Hartzell	Core Network Engineer (HubSpot)	n/a	Core network.	Not contacted
John Cogman	CIO (HubSpot)	n/a	Executive sponsor.	Not contacted. Hold
Aks Zehra	Senior Network Engineer (HubSpot)	n/a	Technical.	CTF ENT Practitioners

Not worth chasing for this goal

Cherry Tang (APAC) and Harrison Stein (Director of Technology, Singapore) cover Asia. The 15+ data center engineers in HubSpot are operators, not buyers; remove Tang from the INTL list.

How the access path should run



Messages, by contact

1. Mike Alford Network Architecture

Why them: Architect; one sharp question.

Channel: Email Mon Oct 5 | Subject: Tower's second path in Chicago

Mike, from your Virtu and KCG days you'll know the Chicago problem: two 'diverse' carriers that share a duct between Cermak and the suburban sites. Crosstown owns underground fiber on-net at 350 E Cermak and Elk Grove, mapped to the conduit. Is Tower's Chicago diversity something you'd want verified against a map?

2. Allison Chen Telecom Engineer

Why them: Circuit owner; offer something useful.

Channel: Email Wed Oct 7 (pause her Practitioners steps) | Subject: A conduit map for your Chicago circuits

Allison, I can send our Chicago conduit map in KMZ so you can check your current circuits for shared paths. No meeting needed. Want it?

The plan

When	Move	Notes
Fri Oct 2	Remove Cherry Tang from CTF INTL; pause Allison Chen in Practitioners.	-
Mon Oct 5	Email Mike Alford; add a LinkedIn connect.	-
Wed Oct 7	Email Allison Chen with the KMZ offer.	-
Mon Oct 12	Email Ben Hartzell if both are silent.	-
Week of Oct 26	Goal: route review with Alford and Chen.	-

What progress looks like (for management)

By	Milestone	How we will know
Oct 16	Reply from Alford or Chen	Logged
Oct 30	Route review held	Meeting logged

Guardrails

- Credits used: 2 Apollo person enrichments; ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company.

Sources

HubSpot contacts and notes (Sep 29-30); Lemlist CTF ENT campaigns; ZoomInfo intent (Sep 12, 26) and scoops; Apollo people data; Trigger Scout Briefing, Oct 1, 2026.